Ch. 14 CW #1 Solutions

1. In the long run, firms' ATC curves are a flatter U-shape and lie below their short run ATC curves. That's because in the long run there are no fixed costs – all costs are variable. As a result, firms have more flexibility to choose their inputs and keep their costs low.

2. (a) – Specialization makes workers more productive. As a result, the firm's marginal costs will fall as they produce more, so average total cost will decrease, and it will exhibit economies of scale.

3. (d) – As production increases, average total cost increases. That means Boeing exhibits diseconomies of scale.

4. (a) Its fixed cost is \$300.

   (b) Marginal cost is the same regardless of whether you calculate it as the change in total cost or the change in variable cost. That's because fixed cost doesn't change when we increase output by one, so the change in total cost is entirely the change in variable cost. Mathematically,

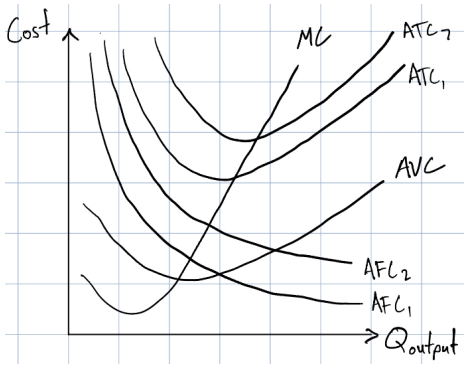
$$\begin{aligned}\Delta TC &= TC_2 - TC_1 \\ &= (FC + VC_2) - (FC + VC_1) \\ &= VC_2 - VC_1 \\ &= \Delta VC\end{aligned}$$

Quantity	TC	VC	$MC = \Delta TC$	$MC = \Delta VC$
0 dozen pizzas	\$300	\$0	–	–
1	350	50	50	50
2	390	90	40	40
3	420	120	30	30
4	450	150	30	30
5	490	190	40	40
6	540	240	50	50

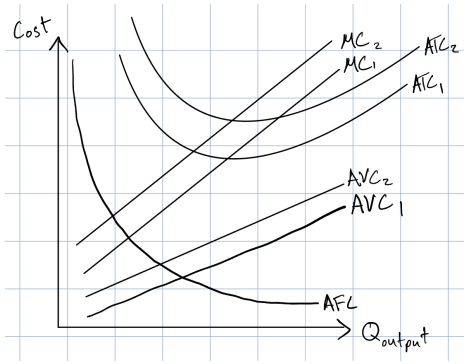
5. The efficient scale of the company is 4 houses painted per month.

Quantity of Houses Painted per Month	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Variable Costs	\$10	\$20	\$40	\$80	\$160	\$320	\$640
$AFC = \frac{FC}{Q}$	200	100	66.67	50	40	33.33	28.57
$AVC = \frac{VC}{Q}$	10	10	13.33	20	32	53.33	91.43
ATC	210	110	80	70	72	96.67	120

6. (a) A lump-sum tax is a single payment that every person or firm (or in this case every hamburger firm) has to pay. A lump-sum tax is a fixed cost, so the average fixed cost and average total cost curves shift. Marginal cost doesn't shift because marginal cost just depends on variable cost (as we saw in 4).



(b) The per-burger tax is a variable cost, so the average variable cost, average total cost, and marginal cost curves shift.



7. ATC: When MC is less than ATC, producing one more unit pulls ATC down, so ATC is decreasing. Similarly, when MC is greater than ATC, producing one more unit pulls ATC up, so ATC is increasing. Therefore, when MC intersects ATC, ATC switches from decreasing to increasing, so ATC is at a minimum.

AVC: When MC is greater than AVC, producing one more unit pulls AVC up, so AVC is increasing.

(a)

Quantity	VC	TC	AVC	ATC	MC
0	0	30	–	–	–
1	10	40	10	40	10
2	25	55	12.5	27.5	15
3	45	75	15	25	20
4	70	100	17.5	25	25
5	100	130	20	26	30
6	135	165	22.5	27.5	35

8. Below is a table of each firm's ATC.

Quantity	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Firm A	\$60	\$35	\$26.67	\$22.5	\$20	\$18.33	\$17.14
Firm B	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
Firm C	21	17	16.33	16.5	17	17.67	18.43

Firm A experiences economies of scale because their ATC decreases as their output increases. Firm B experiences diseconomies of scale because their ATC increases as their output increases. Firm C initially experiences economies of scale and then experiences diseconomies of scale.